

STARBIRTH

Stars are born in vast clouds of interstellar gas and dust called nebulae. Astronomers can see them because of the infrared (heat) radiation and radio waves stars produce when they form. The energetic young stars eventually emerge from the gloom and light up the surrounding cloud.

Dark lanes of dust are the remains of the cloud from which the stars were born

The Trapezium is a clutch of young stars, born only 300,000 years ago

DATA FILE



NUMBER OF NEBULAE IN MILKY WAY: 8,000



SMALLEST NEBULA: G75.78+0.34, 0.05 light years across



LARGEST NEBULA: NGC 604, 1,500 light years across



CLOSEST NEBULA: Horsehead Nebula, 1,250 light years away